

### Problem #3: Yash in Rwanda

#### Solution:

Total Objective: 11 marks

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
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| <b>Assignment 2: Translate to English</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| a) <i>Ibaruwa araandikwa nabogabo</i><br><b>The men are writing the letter. (OR: The letter is being written by the men.)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| b) <i>Ibaruwa araandikwa numugore kuabogabo</i><br><b>The woman is writing the letter for the men.<br/>(OR: The letter is being written by the woman for the men.)</b>                                                                                                                                                        |
| c) <i>Abogabo barabonera umugore abohungu</i><br><b>The men are seeing the boys for the woman.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Assignment 3: Translate to English</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| d) <i>Ikarumu araandiishwa ibaruwa numagabo</i><br><b>The man is writing the letter with the pen. (Or something semantically equivalent)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| e) <i>Abogore barabonerwa abohungu numugabo</i><br><b>The man is seeing the boys for the women. (Or something semantically equivalent)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Assignment 4: Translate to Kinyarwanda</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| f) The boys are writing the book. [2 translations]<br>Translation 1: <i>Abohungu <u>baraandika</u> igitabo</i><br>Translation 2: <i>Igitabo araandikwa nabohungu</i>                                                                                                                                                          |
| g) The boy is writing the book for the women. [4 translations]<br>Translation 1: <i>Umuhungu araandika igitabo kuabogore</i><br>Translation 2: <i>Igitabo araandikwa numuhungu kuabogore</i><br>Translation 3: <i>Umuhungu araandikera abogogore igitabo</i><br>Translation 4: <i>Abogore baraandikerwa igitabo numuhungu</i> |

#### Explanation:

The basic word order is S-V-(O)-(Obl). Obl stands for the oblique case marked argument (prefixed with n- or ku-).

The suffix -er-/iish- on the verb promotes the instrument (n-) or the beneficiary (ku-) argument respectively to the status of the primary object (and the primary object becomes the secondary object).

*In other words,  $S\ V\text{-}a\ O\ ku\text{-}Ben/n\text{-}Instr \rightarrow S\ V\text{-}er/iish\text{-}a\ Ben/Instr\ O$*

*The suffix -wa is turns active sentences into passives. The object is promoted to subject and the subject becomes a n-marked oblique argument.*

*In other words,  $S\ V\text{-}a\ O \rightarrow O\ V\text{-}w\text{-}a\ n\text{-}S$ .*

*-w- can also be paired with -er-/iish-. First, -er-/iish- promotes the oblique argument to object, which is promoted to subject by -w-.*

*In other words:*

*$S\ V\text{-}a\ O\ ku\text{-}Ben/n\text{-}Instr \rightarrow S\ V\text{-}er/iish\text{-}a\ Ben/Instr\ O \rightarrow Ben/Instr\ V\text{-}er/iish\text{-}w\text{-}a\ O\ n\text{-}S$ .*

*Finally, the suffix -a is added after er/iish/w.*

*The verb agrees with the subject (not necessarily denoted by S in the rules above; rather, the argument that precedes the verb) in number. The prefixes for number are: null for singular and b- for plural. (Alternatives such as ara- for singular, and bara- for plural are acceptable.)*

*Animate nouns have the prefix umu- for singular and abo- for plural. (One may also add that inanimate nouns (which only appear in the singular in this data) have the prefix i- : this is not a true generalisation for Kinyarwanda however, though it is true for this data).*

*Before their animacy/number prefix, nouns may also take a case marking prefix: n- for instruments/agents ("with," or "by" or instrumental case) and ku- for beneficiaries ("for" or dative case).*

*The stems are:*

*Nouns: gabo - man, gore - woman, hungu - boy, alimu - teacher, (i)karumu - pen, (i)baruwa - letter, (i)jisho- eye, (i)gitabo - book*

*Verbs: kor - work, gend - go, bon - see, andik - write*

*(the student can also mention the stem with the prefixes ra/ara etc.- (example, rakor or araandik) provided that their prefixes for number (eg. null vs. b-) are compatible with the stems that they give)*